Project Overview

Problem Statement

1. Problem Overview

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders.

Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

2. Current Situation

At present, the flow of work after a standard laptop request is approved depends largely on manual effort:

- A user requests a standard laptop and the request is approved.
- The configuration task is not generated automatically, so someone in IT must remember to create it.
- The task then has to be assigned to the correct team by hand.
- The hardware team may only learn that a laptop needs configuration after the device has already arrived.

Because each of these steps relies on individual awareness rather than a defined, automated process, the outcome varies from one request to the next.

3. Key Issues

Issue	Description
Delays	Configuration starts late because the task is created and assigned manually.
Manual overhead	IT staff spend time creating tasks and following up instead of on higher-value work.
Risk of oversight	A missed or forgotten task leaves an approved laptop unconfigured.
User frustration	Users wait longer for their laptops and have little visibility of progress.
Inefficient resource allocation	Work reaches the hardware team unevenly and without a consistent format.

4. Impact

Stakeholder	Impact
End users	Longer wait before the laptop is ready to use, which affects their productivity.
IT procurement team	Time spent on manual task creation and chasing requests.
Hardware team	Unplanned workload, with tasks arriving late or without clear details.
Organisation	Reduced efficiency in IT operations and a weaker service experience.

5. Root Causes

- No automated link between an approved request and the creation of a configuration task.
- Dependence on manual task creation and assignment.
- No standard task format, such as a consistent short description and assignment group.
- No guaranteed routing of laptop configuration work to the Hardware group.

6. Need for a Solution

A solution is needed that removes the manual steps between approval and configuration. It should generate the configuration task automatically, describe it consistently and route it directly to the Hardware group. Automating this step with ServiceNow Flow Designer addresses each root cause above and gives users a faster, more reliable experience.

The desired end state is a process in which every approved Standard Laptop request results in a correctly assigned configuration task, without any manual intervention from the IT procurement team.

7. Current State versus Desired State

Aspect	Current state	Desired state
Task creation	Created manually by IT staff.	Generated automatically by the flow.
Task assignment	Assigned by hand, if at all.	Assigned directly to the Hardware group.
Task description	Varies from request to request.	Consistent short description and description.
Timeliness	Depends on individual follow-up.	Task exists as soon as the request is approved.
Reliability	Prone to oversight.	Runs the same way for every order.

8. Consequences of Not Addressing the Problem

- Laptops continue to sit unconfigured after they arrive.

- Users continue to experience avoidable delays and uncertainty.
- IT staff continue to spend time on repetitive follow-up.
- The hardware team continues to receive work unevenly and without a standard format.
- The overall efficiency of IT procurement operations remains low.

9. Problem Summary

The core problem is the missing connection between an approved standard laptop request and the configuration work that follows. Closing this gap through automation is the focus of this project, and the sections that follow describe the user story and objectives that guide the solution.